cause. I told him of my run-is with Brig Sandhu, the stressful tenure in Chakrata and about my brush with the Cdr during the Wardec exercise. He asked me about my course gradings and he too was surprised as to how I had got overlooked. It was all very generic; he had never met me before nor did he have any of my documents with him. He told me to make a simple complaint, just asking that my entire profile be reviewed and anything that seemed out of sync should be looked into.

I returned home somewhat lighter at heart. At least there was a plan to work on. On returning to the unit, I quickly wrote out the non-statutory complaint and put it into the pipeline. I also applied for study leave, to pursue a diploma in computer applications, which was granted. The Kargil War had just got over, so there were no longer any restrictions on leave, postings, courses, etc. I came to Delhi and secured admission to a computer course run by the Electronics Trade and Technology Development Corporation Ltd, at Malcha Marg, New Delhi. If I was going to be overlooked, I wasn't going to hang around. I was still young, not yet forty years old, and there were many more avenues to pursue. I spent a peaceful year in Delhi. I had shot my bolt by filing the complaint. My mind was at peace. I attended my classes, played golf, helped the kids with their homework, went to PTA meetings—I did everything possible that was non-military. Rita had got an assignment translating articles from Marathi to English, which she would do by hand. I would then type it up on the computer and send it by email to the DPR. I would also spend time with my father-in-law who was doing arbitration work, being acceptable and sought-after by both the MES as well as the contractors for the honest reputation he had while in service.

By March of 2000, my complaint had been processed and redress given. It was the Cdr from the Meerut tenure who had

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